

THE PLAN OF SALVATION

"What will you do with Jesus?"

Primary Text: Acts 2:36-42 | Sermon Type: Topical | Length: 20 minutes

PROPOSITION:

God has revealed through the gospel how sinners come to Christ: they hear His Word, believe in Jesus Christ, repent of sin, confess Christ, are baptized into Christ, and thereafter live in faithful obedience to Him.

INTRODUCTION - WHAT WILL YOU DO WITH JESUS?

A. The Plan Does Not Begin with Man - It Begins with God.

John 3:16 - "God so loved the world, that he gave..."

Romans 5:8 - "while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us."

Ephesians 2:8 - "For by grace are ye saved through faith..."

B. The Biblical Order. God loved. Christ died. The gospel was revealed. The gospel is preached. Man responds. God saves. The Christian faithfully follows Christ.

C. Key Truth. The six elements are not six human works by which we save ourselves. They are our divinely commanded response to what God has already accomplished through Jesus Christ.

KEY THOUGHT:

God provided the Savior. God provided the gospel. God established the response.

→ *What will you do with Jesus?*

I. HEAR HIS WORD

Romans 10:17 - "faith cometh by hearing..."

A. The gospel must be preached.

B. The gospel must be heard.

C. The gospel produces faith.

1 Corinthians 15:3-4 - Christ died, was buried, and rose again. We preach Jesus, not merely a list of steps.

→ *HEAR HIS WORD.*

II. BELIEVE HIS SON

John 8:24 - "if ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins."

A. Biblical faith is more than knowing about Jesus.

B. Faith trusts Christ enough to respond to Him.

C. Hebrews 11 shows faith moving: Abel offered; Noah prepared; Abraham obeyed.

→ *BELIEVE HIS SON.*

III. REPENT OF SIN

Luke 13:3 - "except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish."

A. **Acts 17:30** - God "commandeth all men every where to repent."

B. **2 Corinthians 7:10** - "godly sorrow worketh repentance..."

C. Sorrow recognizes sin; repentance changes the mind and direction.

→ *REPENT OF SIN.*

IV. CONFESS HIS NAME

Matthew 10:32 - "Whosoever therefore shall confess me before men..."

- A. **Romans 10:9** - "confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus..."
- B. Confession openly acknowledges who Jesus is.
- C. Jesus is the Christ; the Son of God; the Lord.

→ **CONFESS HIS NAME.**

V. BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST

Galatians 3:27 - "baptized into Christ have put on Christ."

- A. Notice the direction: **INTO CHRIST.**
- B. **Romans 6:3-4** - baptized into His death; buried with Him; raised to walk in newness of life.
- C. **Acts 2:38** - "Repent, and be baptized... for the remission of sins."
- D. **Acts 22:16** - "arise, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins..."

Baptism is not trusting in water; it is trusting Christ's saving work enough to submit to His command.

→ **BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST.**

VI. OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY

Acts 2:41-42 - "were baptized... continued stedfastly..."

- A. Baptism is not the finish line; it is the beginning of Christian life.
- B. **Matthew 28:20** - "Teaching them to observe all things..."
- C. **Revelation 2:10** - "be thou faithful unto death..."

The Christian life: Saved → Transformed → Serving → Growing → Enduring → Faithful.

→ **OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY.**

CONCLUSION - WHAT WILL YOU DO WITH JESUS?

The question is not, "Do you know the six steps?" A person can memorize six steps and never surrender his life to Christ.

Will you hear His Word? Believe His Son? Repent of sin? Confess His name? Be baptized into Christ? Obey Him faithfully?

GOSPEL INVITATION	SERMON REFRAIN
God has spoken. Christ has died, been buried, and arisen. The gospel has been preached. What will you do with Jesus?	Hear His Word. Believe His Son. Repent of Sin. Confess His Name. Be Baptized into Christ. Obey Him Faithfully.

God provided the grace. Christ provided the blood. The Spirit revealed the Word. The gospel provides the message.

→ **WHAT WILL YOU DO WITH JESUS?**